The peace deals greatly increased the stature of militants and brought them at par with the military authorities and enervated the centuries-old jirga and tribal Malik systems. None of the peace deals lasted for more than a few months and gave way to a renewed cycle of violence. The Taliban repeatedly used the same deadly tactics that proved effective in bringing the government to the negotiating table. They used the tactics whenever they needed breathing space from a military operation to regroup and rejuvenate their ranks and supplies.

Peace deals also redirect the attention of Taliban towards Afghanistan increasing cross-border attacks and activities. The let up in military action in Pakistan helped Taliban to focus on Afghanistan.

In October 2011, Prime Minister Yousuf Raza Gillani said that the government was ready to start talks with all factions of the Taliban, including the Haqqani network. A TTP commander admitted that preliminary talks were in progress and initially peace in South Waziristan was under discussion. However, it was not easy to initiate talk with a number of groups operating across FATA. A tribal mediator described the talks as 'very difficult' (*The Express Tribune*, 2011). Secondly, the main military operation was being carried out in South Waziristan and therefore talking about peace in this area meant to succumb to the TTP tactic to get pressure off them and start negotiations on their terms. Thirdly, the US, the source of billions of dollars of aid vital for Pakistan's military and feeble economy, may not look kindly on peace talks with the TTP, which it labelled a terrorist group. 'The US won't be happy,' said Rahimullah Yusufzai, a Pakistani expert on the Taliban. 'If there is less pressure from Pakistan on the militants then they (the Pakistani Taliban) will turn their attention to Afghanistan' (*The Express Tribune*, 2011). When there was a two-month lull in drone attacks at the end of 2011 after the NATO attack on the Salala check post, the TTP, Afghan Taliban and Al Qaeda started reuniting and rejuvenating their strength.

It was evident that past peace pacts with the TTP always backfired and merely gave the group time and space to consolidate, launch fresh attacks and impose their austere version of Islam on segments of the population. There was a massive mistrust between the parties, and both blamed each other for the violations of pacts. Despite repeated failures of peace deals, some quarters insisted on negotiated settlement. Some strategists believed that talks should remain an integral part of the COIN strategy to bring lulls and breathing spaces, which could